

Delving Deeper Monster Matrices

Wandering-monster tables for *Delving Deeper*, in the form of the OED Monster Matrices: roll on the Monster Level Matrix for the dungeon level, then on the Monster Level Table it points to, and size the encounter with Number Appearing. The tables rank monsters by Equivalent Hit Dice (EHD), a measure of real fighting strength computed with Dan Collins's Arena combat simulator, rather than by hit dice alone; the companion *Monster Stat Blocks* handout gives every monster's EHD. Monsters carry the names of Delving Deeper's Table 3.1; how the tables were built is set out in the colophon.

Monster Level Matrix

Dungeon level	Monster level					
	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	1–4	5	6	–	–	–
2	1–2	3–4	5	6	–	–
3–4	1	2	3–4	5	6	–
5–7	–	1	2	3–4	5	6
8–10	–	–	1	2	3–4	5–6
11+	–	–	–	1	2	3–6

Roll 1d6 on the row for the dungeon level; the result gives the monster level table to use.

Monster Level Tables

Level 1 (EHD 1)

d14	Monster
1	Ants, giant
2	Gnolls
3	Goblins
4	Hobgoblins
5	Kobolds
6	Lizardmen
7	Lizards, large
8	Men, Bandits
9	Orcs
10	Rats, giant
11	Skeletons
12	Snakes, large
13	Spiders, large
14	Zombies

Level 3 (EHD 3–4)

d16	Monster
1	Androids
2	Beetles, giant (4–7 HD)
3	Cyborgs
4	Doppelgangers
5	Gargoyles
6	Ghouls
7	Gray ooze
8	Lycanthropes (Wereboars/Weretigers/Werebears)
9	Minotaurs
10	Ochre jelly
11	Ogres
12	Thulls
13	Toads, giant
14	Wight apes
15	Wights
16	Wraiths

Level 2 (EHD 2)

d8	Monster
1	Bats, giant
2	Beetles, giant (2–3 HD)
3	Centipedes, large
4	Dragons, hatchling
5	Lizards, giant
6	Lycanthropes (Werewolves)
7	Shadows
8	Weasels, giant

Level 4 (EHD 5–7)

d15	Monster
1	Centipedes, giant
2	Cockatrices
3	Dragons, young
4	Gelatinous cube
5	Green slime
6	Hydras (5 heads)
7	Manticoras
8	Mummies
9	Robots
10	Scorpions, giant
11	Snakes, giant
12	Spectres
13	Spiders, giant
14	Trolls
15	Yellow mold

Level 5 (EHD 8–10)

d5	Monster
1	Dragons, adult
2	Giants (Hill/Stone/Frost)
3	Hydras (6–7 heads)
4	Salamanders
5	Wyverns

Level 6 (EHD 11+)

d15	Monster
1	Basilisks
2	Black pudding
3	Chimeras
4	Dragons, mature, old or ancient
5	Giants (Fire/Cloud/Storm)
6	Golems (Flesh/Clay)
7	Gorgons
8	Gothrogs
9	Hydras (8–12 heads)
10	Juggernaut
11	Living statues (Stone/Iron)
12	Medusae
13	Purple worms
14	Titan
15	Vampires

Number Appearing

Assume a party of four characters. Wandering monsters appear 1d3 at a time (average 2), on the assumption that dungeon level equates to Equivalent Hit Dice. If the matrix cell rolled lies in the column that contains the 3–4 result for that dungeon level, use the number as rolled; for columns to the left or right, multiply as follows.

Column	Multiplier
Two to the left	×3
One to the left	×2
One to the right	×½
Two to the right	×⅓

For dungeon lairs, with or without treasure, place 1d6 monsters (average 3.5) and modify in the same way. This guide is not meant for the deepest levels (11+), where monster levels and EHDs vary greatly; there, multiply the number by the ratio of dungeon level to EHD (the stat-block document gives the exact EHDs). If the party is larger or smaller than four, scale the numbers in proportion. At least one monster appears in any encounter, which may be very dangerous.

Colophon

How the tables were built. The Monster Level Matrix is Dan's (Arena's `MonsterLevelMatrix.csv`). The Monster Level Tables are rebuilt from the Delving Deeper EHDs with Arena's banding (`EHDToTable.csv`), with families collapsed and dragons placed by age as follows.

- **Which monsters are listed.** As in Arena, only monsters of the dungeon environment with an EHD of 1 or more: not Bats; Horses, Mule (EHD 0, they do not attack) and not the 91 monsters of the wilderness, the water or other planes (among them the men other than bandits, the dinosaurs, the elementals and the sea monsters).
- **Families.** Where Delving Deeper gives one monster a range of hit dice (giant beetles, hydras), each table lists the sizes whose EHD falls in its band. Giants, lycanthropes, golems and living statues are one entry per table with the kinds in parentheses; the two giant snakes are Delving Deeper's single entry. The rules are in `families.json`.
- **Dice.** Roll the die shown, or a larger die and roll again on a result above the table. Level 5 is short because the Delving Deeper EHDs cluster in the 3–4 and 11+ bands.
- **Dragons.** Arena gives a dragon hit points of $HD \times \text{age category}$ (its OD&D idiom, where a dragon's HD are fixed), so the EHDs in the database make hatchlings far too weak and old dragons far too strong. For the tables the dragons were therefore measured again with ordinary hit dice (`dragon-ehd.tsv` from `dragon-ehd.sh`, in which golden dragons lose their spells) and each age is placed by the median of its six colours. The grid gives that HD-only EHD for each age and colour, and the level table the median places the age in, so that a colour can be moved up or down:

Age	EHD with ordinary hit dice						Level
	White	Black	Green	Blue	Red	Golden	
Hatchling	2	2	3	3	3	2	2
Young	4	5	6	8	8	5	4
Adult	7	8	10	11	13	11	5
Mature	10	12	14	16	19	17	6
Old	15	17	22	25	29	31	6
Ancient	21	26	28	33	40	48	6

Delving Deeper is a retroclone of the original 1974 edition of the fantasy role-playing game, written by Simon J. Bull and published by Immersive Ink (ddo.immersiveink.com). This document is modelled on Dan Collins's OED handout of the same name (oedgames.com). Every value comes from `MonsterDatabase-DelvingDeeper.csv`, an Arena monster database of the Delving Deeper reference rules; the Equivalent Hit Dice (EHD) were computed by running Dan's Arena combat simulator on the Delving Deeper statistics. The database and the script that produced this document live in github.com/karsalfrink/Arena, directory `tools/delving-deeper/`; the database is proposed upstream in [danielrcollins1/Arena pull request 6](https://github.com/danielrcollins1/Arena/pull/request/6). The database and this document were produced with a large language model (Anthropic's Claude) under the review of Kars Alfrink; the README in that directory says how. Generated from `MonsterDatabase-DelvingDeeper.csv` at commit 5d6cad5 (7 September 2026).